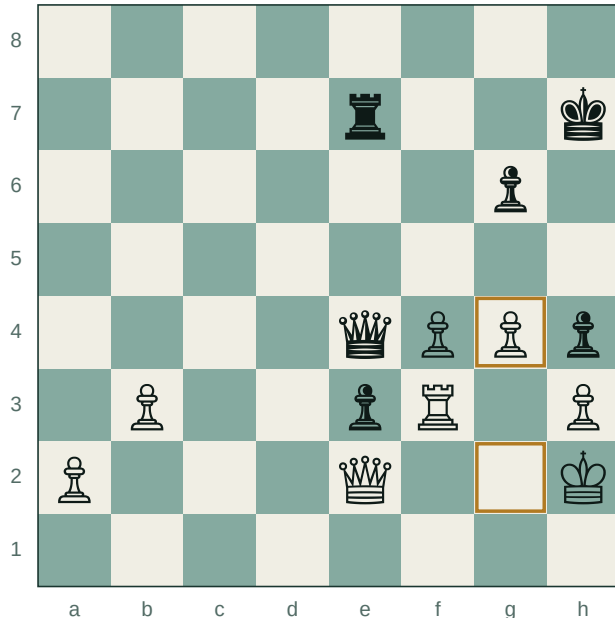


Calculated sacrifices: Black, move 49

Calculated sacrifices

Black to move



Previous move: 49.g4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

49...Qxf3 50. Qxf3 e2 51. Qc3 e1=Q 52. Qxe1 Rxe1

49...Qxf3 The queen captures the rook on f3. Recorded reply: **50.Qxf3**.

50...e2 The pawn moves from e3 to e2. Recorded reply: **51.Qc3**.

51...e1=Q The pawn moves from e2 to e1. The pawn becomes a queen. Recorded reply: **52.Qxe1**.

52...Rxe1 The rook captures the queen on e1.

At the end, nominal material is White 5 / Black 7 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from -2 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on h2. Geometrically undefended: queen on e2. Check for tactical protection.